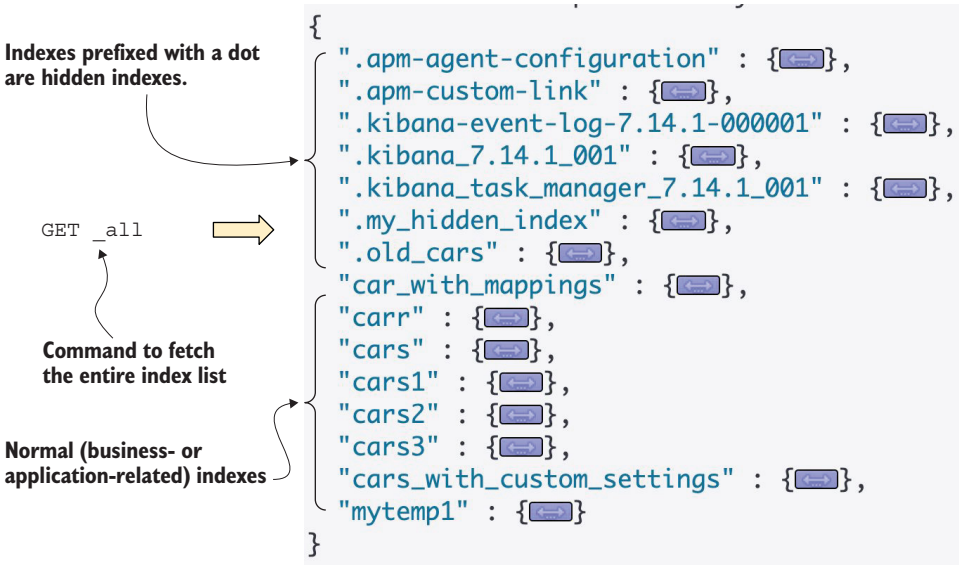


Figure 6.5 Fetching a list of all public and hidden indexes

6.4 Deleting indexes

Deleting an existing index is straightforward: a `DELETE` action on the index (like `DELETE <index_name>`) deletes the index permanently. For example, issuing a `DELETE cars` command deletes the `cars` index when the command is issued, meaning all the documents in that index are gone—forever—including any settings, mapping schemas, and aliases!

Deleting multiple indexes

We can also delete multiple indexes. Append a comma-separated list of indexes to delete them simultaneously.

Listing 6.25 Deleting multiple indexes

```
DELETE cars,movies,order
```

We can delete indexes using a wildcard pattern as well: `DELETE *`. However, if we also want to delete hidden indexes, we must use the `_all` endpoint: `DELETE _all`. Note that we must set the `action.destructive_requires_name` property to `false` when attempting to delete indexes with a wildcard or `_all`:

```
PUT _cluster/settings
{
 "transient": {
   "action.destructive_requires_name":false
 }
}
```